

Confidentiality & Safety Agreement

For participants in peer support groups facilitated by [Organization Name]

Our Commitment

We create a space where people can speak honestly about their experiences without fear of judgment, exposure, or harm. This agreement protects everyone in the group.

Confidentiality

****Everything shared in this group stays in this group.**** This includes identities, stories, and any personal information disclosed during sessions.

****No screenshots, recordings, or notes that identify others.**** You may take personal notes for yourself, but do not record audio, video, or photographs of any session unless every participant has given explicit written consent.

****Outside the group**** — do not discuss other members' stories, even without names. Context can identify someone.

Exceptions (required by law and ethics)

We may need to break confidentiality if:

- Someone is at ****immediate risk of serious harm**** (to themselves or others)
- There is ****suspected abuse of a child, elder, or vulnerable adult****
- We receive a ****valid legal order**** (subpoena or court order)

If we must break confidentiality, we will tell you first whenever possible.

Safety Guidelines

****No fixing.**** Peer support is not therapy or advice-giving. Listen, reflect, and share your own experience if it helps.

****Share what you're comfortable with.**** You never have to disclose more than you want to.

****One person speaks at a time.**** No interrupting, no cross-talk.

****Avoid identifying details when sharing.**** It's okay to say "someone in my life" instead of naming a person.

****No solicitation.**** Do not promote businesses, services, or personal causes during group time.

****Substance-free.**** Please attend sessions without the influence of alcohol or non-prescribed substances.

Between Sessions

- You may exchange contact information with other members if everyone agrees.
- Group facilitators are available during sessions only. If you need support between sessions, please reach out to your personal support network or a crisis line.

Acknowledgment

By participating in this group, I agree to uphold these confidentiality and safety guidelines. I understand that violating confidentiality may result in removal from the group.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Group: _____

This agreement is reviewed at the start of each session. Members may propose updates at any time.